

Lesson 0.4 - Paper Airplane Design Process Worksheet

Graded classwork | Individual worksheet | Small-team build/test activity | Engineering notebook document #1

Name: _____

Period: _____

Date: _____

Challenge Summary

Your team will use the engineering design process to design a paper airplane for distance. Each team gets one sheet of paper for Version 1 and one new sheet of paper for Version 2. Nothing else may be used. Official distance is measured from the launch line to where the airplane first touches the ground, using feet and inches.

1. Define Problem

What are you trying to improve? What counts as success?

2. Generate Concepts

Sketch one possible paper airplane design. Your team will compare ideas and choose one to build.

3. Develop Solution

Record the team design choice and why it was selected.

4. Construct & Test

Build Version 1, complete one official flight, revise, then build and test Version 2.

5. Evaluate Solution

Use the distance data to decide whether Version 2 improved, got worse, or stayed the same.

6. Present Solution

Summarize what your team changed and which design process step mattered most.

Define Problem

Write the design problem in your own words and list what will make the airplane successful.

Generate Concepts - Individual Sketch

Sketch one paper airplane concept. Label at least two important design features, such as wing shape, nose shape, folds, or stabilizers.

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Page 2 | Record evidence, evaluate the redesign, and prepare the worksheet for the engineering notebook.

Name: _____ Period: _____ Date: _____

Develop Solution

Which design did your team choose to build for Version 1? Why did your team choose it?

Version	Design Change	Distance	Notes
Version 1			
Version 2			

Evaluate Solution

Did Version 2 improve, get worse, or stay about the same compared with Version 1? Use distance data as evidence.

Present Solution / Reflection

What did your team change from Version 1 to Version 2, and why? Which design process step was most important during this challenge? Explain your answer.

Before adding to your notebook: Make sure this worksheet is complete, thoughtful, numbered as document #1, listed in the Table of Contents, and placed in the engineering notebook.